UNIVERSITY CITY CRIME DATA

Ten years of numbers, four different geographies.

Penn Clery · Pennsylvania UCR · PPD Citywide · UPennAlerts

Compiled from public sources · 2015–2025

FRAMING

Four geographies. Don't mix them up.

Every crime stat about "Penn" or "University City" is measured against a different boundary. These numbers are not interchangeable.

Penn Patrol Zone

30th–43rd, Market–Baltimore

Penn Police primary jurisdiction. Reported in the Annual Security & Fire Safety Report (Clery).

Clery "Campus"

Penn-owned + adjacent public

Federal definition. Narrower than the Patrol Zone — only Penn-owned/controlled buildings and immediately adjacent public property.

Pennsylvania UCR

Broader Penn-policed area

State-mandated reporting. Counts Part 1 offenses, normalized by full-time equivalent (FTE) students + employees.

PPD Citywide

All of Philadelphia

Philadelphia Police Department. Used here for citywide context (homicides), not for direct comparison to Penn data.

Data sources & approach

SOURCES

Penn Annual Security & Fire Safety Reports

2020 ASR (covers 2017–19), 2022 ASR (2019–21), 2025 ASR (2022–24). Clery counts in Penn Patrol Zone.

Penn Pennsylvania UCR submissions

Annual Part 1 offense counts + FTE denominators, 2017–2024.

Philadelphia Police Department

Citywide homicide totals, 2007–2025 (YTD).

UPennAlerts archive

Real-time campus alerts, partial coverage 2019–2021.

APPROACH

10 years targeted
2015–2024 for Clery (2015–16 backfill noted as gap); 2017–2024 for PA UCR; 2007–2025 for citywide homicides.

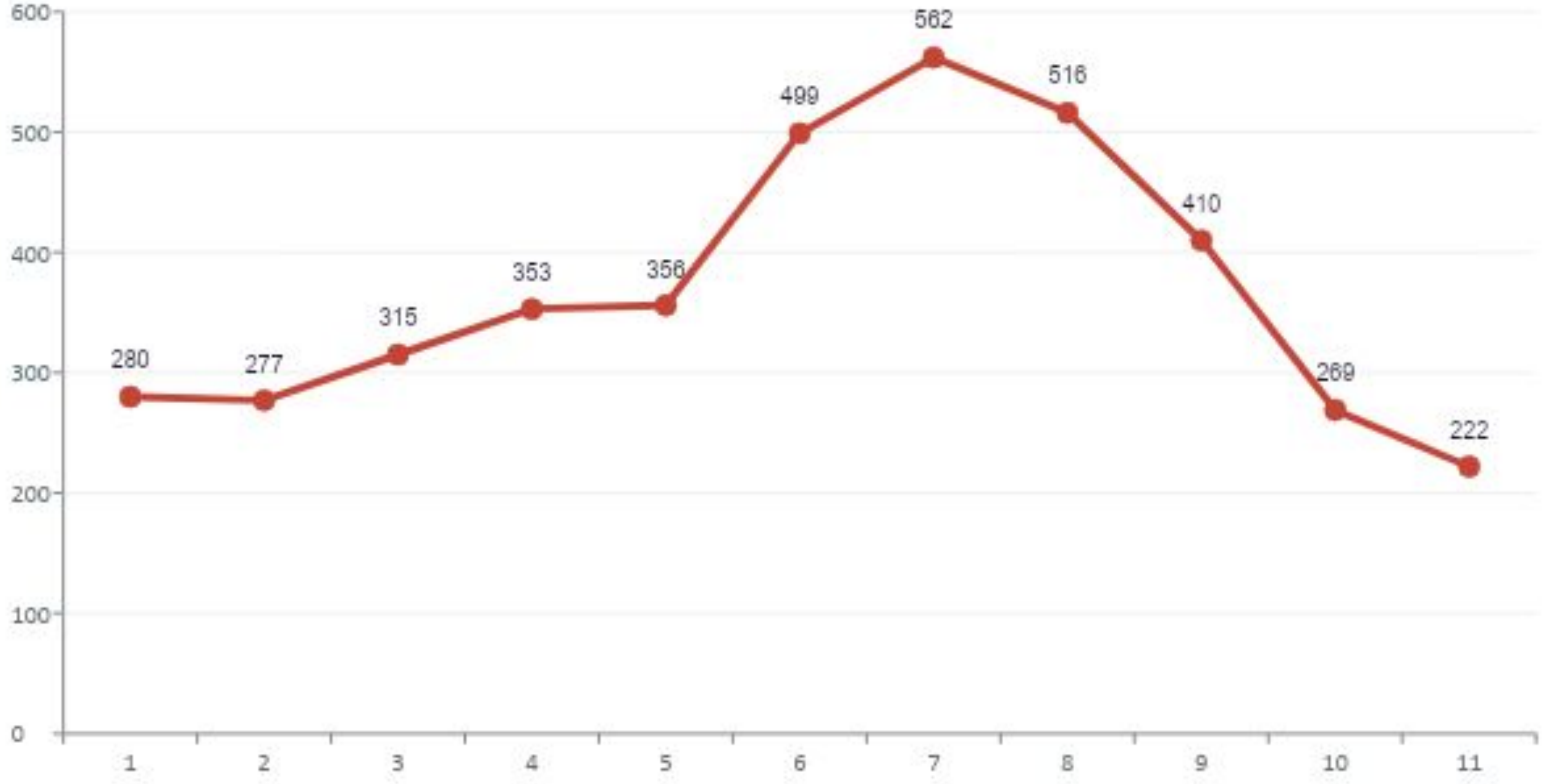
Authoritative when revised
When ASRs revise prior-year numbers, the most recent ASR's figure is used. 2019 was revised between the 2020 and 2022 reports.

No cross-geography math
Patrol Zone, Clery campus, PA UCR area, and citywide totals are presented separately. No ratios or growth rates across boundaries.

Reproducible
All CSVs + Python build script published alongside this deck.

Homicides peaked in 2021. Down 60% since.

Crime perceptions on campus are shaped by what's happening across Philadelphia. Citywide homicides ran from a 2021 peak of 562 to roughly 222 in 2025 — among the steepest drops in any major U.S. city.



562

homicides in 2021

All-time city record

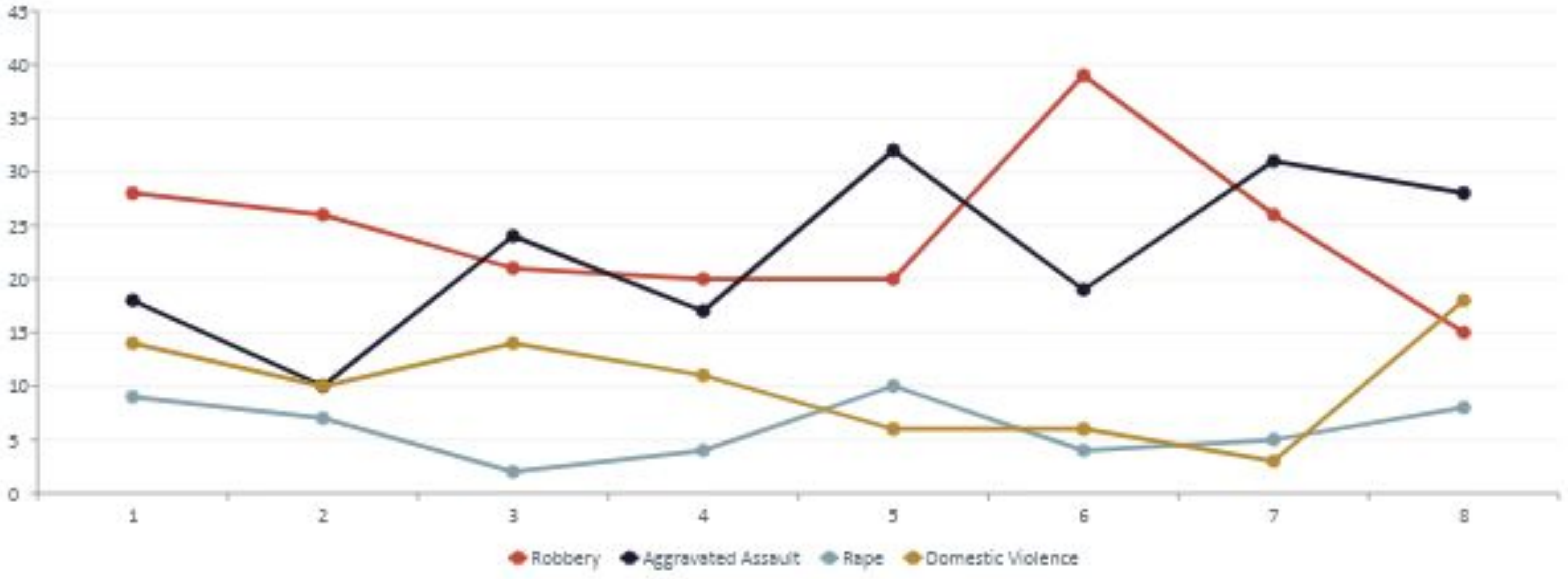
−60%

from 2021 peak to 2025

YTD figures, ~222 in 2025

Violent crime in the Patrol Zone is roughly flat.

Eight years of Clery data from the Penn Patrol Zone (30th–43rd, Market–Baltimore). No clear secular trend — year-to-year noise dominates. Robbery has trended down; aggravated assault has trended modestly up.



CAVEATS

What this data doesn't show.

Reporting bias

Sex offenses, domestic violence, and hate crimes are under-reported across all jurisdictions. A drop in counts can reflect lower reporting, not lower incidence.

Geographic gaps

Crimes one block outside the Patrol Zone don't appear in Clery — but students still experience them. The boundary is administrative, not behavioral.

Severity is flat

A robbery and an attempted robbery count the same. No injury severity, no weapon detail, no outcome tracking.

Definitions change

Clery categories were redefined in 2014 (VAWA amendments). Older years aren't strictly comparable to newer ones.

2015–16 Clery gap

ASRs from those years are not in Penn's current archive. Backfill via the federal Campus Safety database (linked in repo).

Lag

Clery numbers for year N are published in October of year N+1. The freshest year here is 2024.

If you want to know whether a place feels safe, this dataset is a starting point — not an answer.

UNIVERSITY CITY RENT DATA

Thousands of renters, two different markets.

US Census Philadelphia· City Data Philadelphia

Which Datasets We Are Using

US Census Philadelphia

Collected by the US Census Bureau

Philadelphia citywide demographic, housing, rent, and household estimates used for benchmark comparisons. Variables include population density, median age, household size, family households, and rent distributions.

City Data Philadelphia – University City

Public Data

Neighborhood-level estimates for University City used to compare local trends against Philadelphia overall. Includes population, density, household structure, and rental market characteristics.

Data Sources & Approach

APPROACH

Comparative neighborhood analysis

University City metrics were compared directly against Philadelphia citywide values to evaluate whether university-centered neighborhoods differ from the broader city.

Rent over raw counts proportions

Because Philadelphia has far more households than University City, rental categories were converted into percentages for fair comparison.

Aligned category bins

Citywide rent ranges were regrouped to match University City rent categories (ex: $200–$299, $300–$399, etc.).

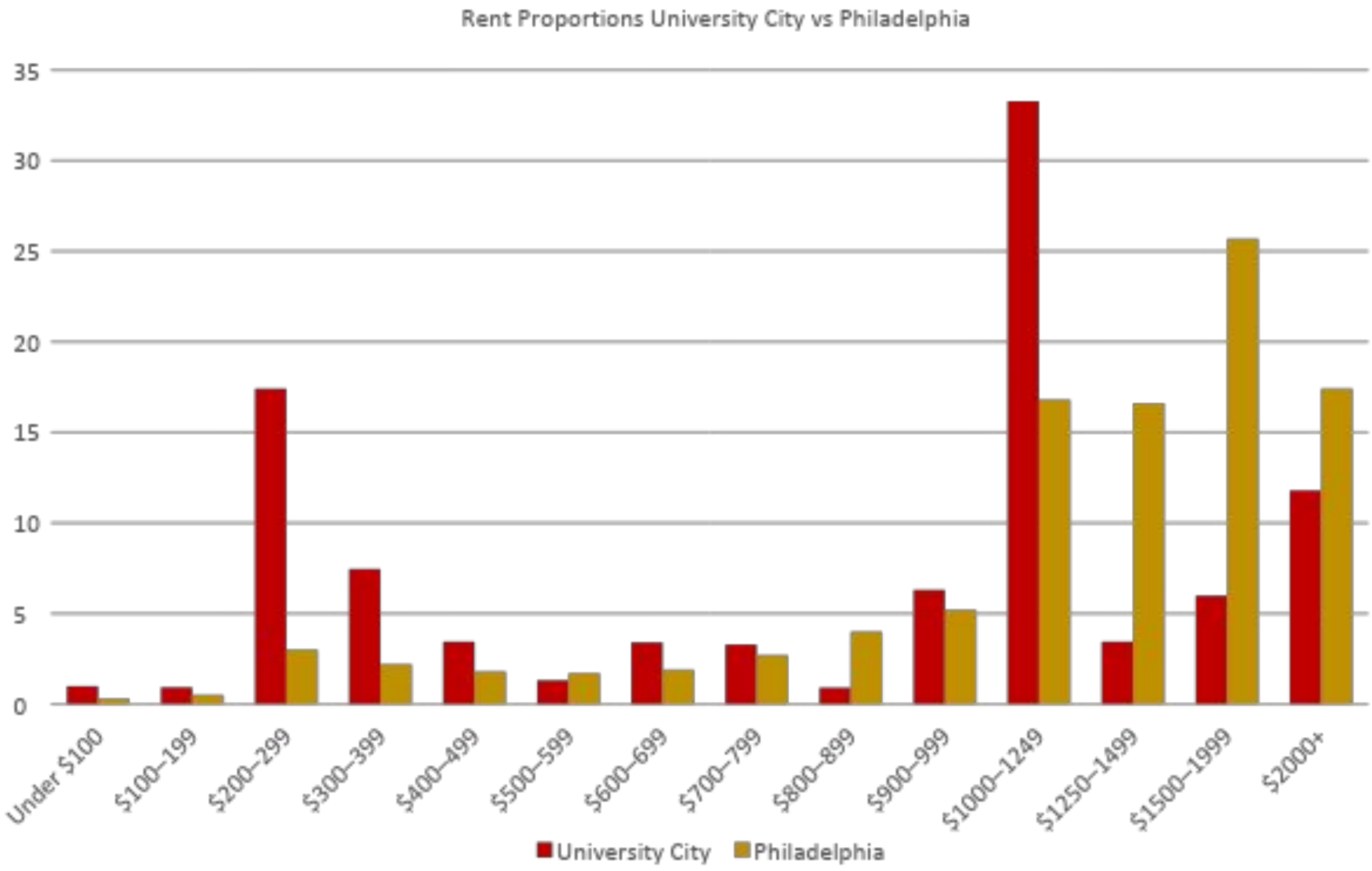
Reproducible workflow

All cleaning, merging, calculations, and charts were produced in Jupyter Notebook using Python so results can be replicated.

Research question driven

The project evaluates whether universities shape cities through measurable effects on housing markets, demographics, and neighborhood structure.

Rent Findings



33%

largest University City share in
$1,000–$1,249 rents

Most common rent tier

26%

Philadelphia share in
$1,500–$1,999 rents

Higher-cost citywide concentration

CAVEATS

Key Caveats to Note

Different data sources

University City and Philadelphia figures may come from different datasets or estimation methods, which can affect direct comparability.

Boundary definitions

The geographic boundaries of “University City” may vary by source, so results depend on how the neighborhood is defined.

Student housing effects

Shared apartments, roommate households, and student leasing patterns may distort rent distributions compared with typical residential neighborhoods.

UNIVERSITY CITY BUSINESS DATA

Thousands of businesses, two different geographies.

Penn buffer (1000m) · Outside University City
Open Data Philly · 2026

Which Datasets and Parameters We Are Using

Philadelphia Business Licenses Dataset

Public Data

Citywide dataset of all licensed businesses, including location, license type, and status. Used to analyze overall business composition across Philadelphia.

University City (Zip Code 19104)

Filtered subset of business license data

Represents the broader university-adjacent neighborhood used for comparison against the rest of the city.

Penn Campus Buffer (1000m radius)

Spatially filtered dataset

Captures businesses within walking distance of campus, used to analyze how proximity to Penn shapes local economic activity.

Data Sources & Approach

APPROACH

Comparative spatial analysis

Business composition within a 1000 m radius of University of Pennsylvania was compared to areas outside University City to evaluate how proximity to a major university shapes local economic structure.

Categorization of license types

Individual business license types were consolidated into broader categories (housing, food & dining, infrastructure, retail & services) to simplify analysis and highlight dominant economic patterns.

Proportions over raw counts

Because Philadelphia contains far more total businesses than the Penn area, all categories were converted into percentages to allow meaningful comparison across differently sized geographies.

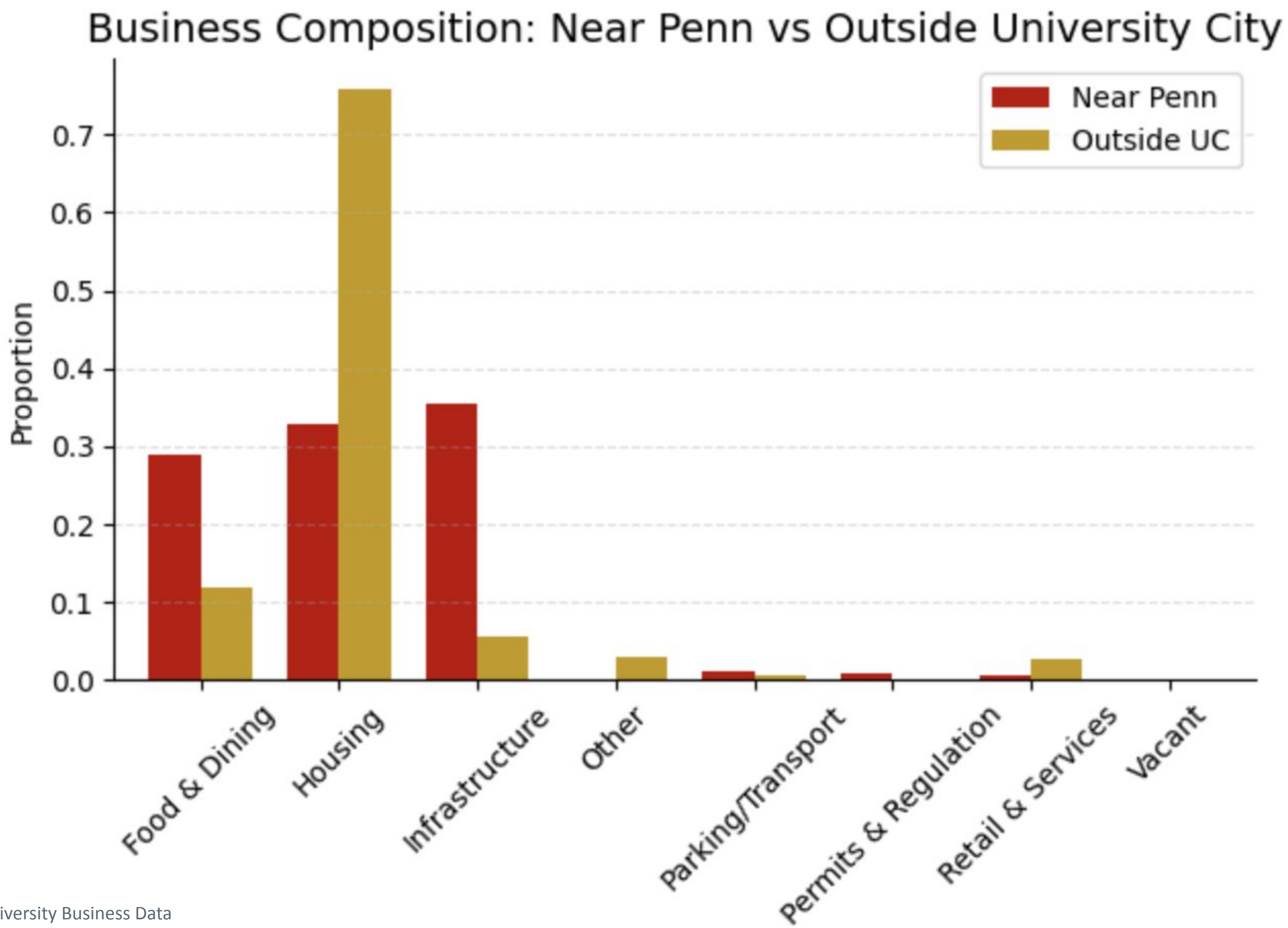
Reproducible workflow

All cleaning, merging, calculations, and charts were produced in Jupyter Notebook using Python so results can be replicated.

Research question driven

The project evaluates whether universities shape cities through measurable effects on housing markets, demographics, and neighborhood structure.

Business Findings



35%

Infrastructure Near Penn: building maintenance, trash removal/waste systems, etc.

Largest category in campus area

75%

Housing outside University City

Dominant category citywide

Key Caveats to Note

Geographic boundaries

Results depend on how “University City” and the Penn buffer are defined. Nearby areas just outside these boundaries may still be influenced by the university.

License vs. activity

Business licenses indicate the presence of a business, not its size, revenue, or level of activity.

Category simplification

Detailed license types were grouped into broader categories, which may obscure differences between specific types of businesses.